CASE STUDY 01 / 05

Customer Intake & Verification

Advanced Word operations packet • source-to-master reconciliation

BUSINESS SCENARIO

An operations shared-services team receives 12 customer onboarding forms from a sales queue. The inputs have inconsistent casing, duplicate entities, and one missing required field. The specialist must normalize data without silently inventing values and publish a traceable accepted-record register.

COMPLETED DELIVERABLE Validated master register, transformation mapping, documented exception disposition, QA acceptance summary, and a repeatable entry SOP.

ROLE COVERAGE

Data Entry Clerk • Data Verification Specialist • Data Processor

EVIDENCE AT A GLANCE

12	9	3
SOURCE RECORDS	APPROVED RECORDS	RESOLVED / HELD

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Portfolio disclosure: All organizations, records, people, and transactions are fictional. This is a simulated work product, not a claim of past paid employment or client work.

01 / INTAKE CONTROL PLAN

Task brief: move raw onboarding submissions into a controlled master file; preserve source IDs and route exceptions.

Field specification & acceptance rules

Field	Expected value	Gate / normalization
Source ID	SRC-###	Unique ID; never overwrite original
Legal customer name	2–80 characters	Trim whitespace; title case only after source check
Primary contact	First + last	Trim/collapse repeated spaces
Email	user@domain.example	Required; lowercase; syntax check; do not infer
Region	US two-letter code	Valid state; uppercase; keep original in audit
Enrollment date	YYYY-MM-DD	Valid date; must not postdate batch close
Status	Accepted / Duplicate / Hold	No silent deletion of source lines

Processing safeguards

- Use source ID as the immutable evidence key; do not use a person name as a primary identifier.
- Duplicate detection: exact normalized email plus business name review; a possible match triggers manual review, not automatic deletion.
- Record corrections are reversible: log before value, after value, reason, reviewer decision, and batch timestamp.
- Unknown or absent required values remain on hold until an authorized source supplies them.

BATCH SCOPE

Batch INTAKE-2026-10-27-A; fictional Northbridge Client Services. Source window: 2026-10-19 to 2026-10-26. Audit clock: Eastern Time. No live personal information used.

02 / SOURCE CAPTURE

Raw intake received (unaltered source representation)

ID	Customer (as entered)	Contact / email (as entered)	Region
001	NorthWay Office Supplies	Mira Kent / MIRA.KENT@northway.example	nc
002	Cedar Pine Logistics	Eli Porter / eli.porter@cedarpine.example	SC
003	Northway Office Supply	Mira Kent / mira.kent@northway.example	NC
004	laurel brook studio	Dana Ross / dana.ross@laurelbrook.example	va
005	Harbor North Dental	Rina Sol / rina.sol@harbornorth.example	NC
006	W. Glen Holdings	Jules Reed / jules.reed@westglen.example	ga
007	West Glen Holdings	Jules Reed / JULES.REED@westglen.example	GA
008	Aster Labs	Noel Park / noel.park@asterlabs.example	NC
009	Marble Finch LLC	Ada Ford / ada.ford@marblefinch.example	nc
010	Hollow Creek Foods	Lia Moss / [missing]	TN
011	Pine Lake Co	Beck Lee / beck.lee@pinelake.example	TX
012	Morningside Solar	Arlo Vega / arlo.vega@morningside.example	NC

Source-level checks

Every submission was assigned its source key before editing. Two source rows were flagged as duplicate candidates by normalized email, and one lacked an email. Dates are a documented validation field but are not reproduced in this source excerpt. No rejection was hidden from the batch count.

03 / FINAL APPROVED REGISTER

Master records published to the accepted queue

Master ID	Source	Customer name	Primary email	ST
C-001	001	Northway Office Supplies	mira.kent@northway.example	NC
C-002	002	Cedar Pine Logistics	eli.porter@cedarpine.example	SC
C-003	004	Laurel Brook Studio	dana.ross@laurelbrook.example	VA
C-004	005	Harbor North Dental	rina.sol@harbornorth.example	NC
C-005	006	W. Glen Holdings	jules.reed@westglen.example	GA
C-006	008	Aster Labs	noel.park@asterlabs.example	NC
C-007	009	Marble Finch LLC	ada.ford@marblefinch.example	NC
C-008	011	Pine Lake Co	beck.lee@pinelake.example	TX
C-009	012	Morningside Solar	arlo.vega@morningside.example	NC

Normalization applied

Rule	Evidence	Disposition
Trim and case	SRC-001, SRC-004, SRC-009	Spacing and letter case standardized
Uppercase state	SRC-001, 004, 006, 009	NC / VA / GA normalized
Lowercase email	SRC-001, SRC-007	Address normalized for comparison
Canonical naming	SRC-006 + SRC-007	Retain SRC-006 name pending brand verification

RECONCILIATION

12 source rows = 9 accepted master rows + 2 duplicate rows + 1 held row. Every source key has exactly one batch disposition.

04 / EXCEPTION REGISTER & EVIDENCE

Decision log

Exception	Source	Finding	Action / reason	State
EX-01	003	Same email as SRC-001; minor name variant	Link to C-001. Preserve source; do not create second account.	Closed
EX-02	007	Same email as SRC-006; name expanded	Link to C-005. Require separate legal-name verification before change.	Closed
EX-03	010	Required primary email missing	Hold entry; request verified contact email from sales owner.	Open

Representative audit trail

Batch step	When (ET)	Recorded evidence
Import capture	2026-10-27 09:05	12 immutable source keys allocated
Validation run	2026-10-27 09:22	3 exceptions raised; 9 provisional accepts
Manual review	2026-10-27 09:45	2 exact-email duplicate candidates confirmed
QA sample	2026-10-27 10:10	9 accepted records compared against source
Release	2026-10-27 10:30	9 accepted; 1 hold routed to sales queue

Correction versus assumption

The apparent spelling difference between “W. Glen Holdings” and “West Glen Holdings” was not expanded in the approved legal-name field. The match was sufficient to prevent a duplicate account, but not sufficient to assert a legal-name correction. This separation demonstrates controlled verification rather than guesswork.

05 / SOP & RELEASE

Standard operating procedure — customer record intake

01 Save the intake export as a read-only source snapshot and assign the intake batch identifier.

02 Apply field-level checks: required values, date format, valid state code, email syntax, and length limits.

03 Standardize only safe formatting differences (case, leading/trailing whitespace); retain original values in the exception evidence.

04 Run exact normalized-email duplicate screening and inspect likely entity-name matches manually.

05 Assign each source row one and only one status: Accepted, Duplicate, or Hold.

06 Create master IDs for accepted rows. Link duplicates to the canonical master without discarding source evidence.

07 Reconcile source, master, duplicates, and holds; obtain QA review before releasing an approved output.

08 Escalate missing mandatory fields to the authorized owner; do not fabricate or backfill from unverified third-party sources.

Acceptance evidence

PASS 12/12 source IDs accounted for; none lost or silently deleted.

PASS 9/9 accepted records contain contact, email, state, and source lineage.

PASS 0 duplicate primary emails among the 9 accepted master records.

PASS 1 unresolved missing-email item held outside the released register.

CONTROLLED RELEASE

Control	Final result
Document owner	Client Data Operations / QA
Review state	Approved for training portfolio
Review date	2026-10-27
Data classification	Fictional sample / no real personal, financial, or medical data

07 / ORIGINAL VS FINAL

Evidence pack: source-to-output lineage

Companion CSV files contain the exact 12 raw forms, nine accepted rows, and three exceptions. The two duplicate candidates and one incomplete intake never enter the published master.

Control test	Expected	Reperformed result
Input reconciliation	12 = 9 + 2 + 1	PASS / 12 source IDs accounted for
Master primary-email uniqueness	9 unique addresses	PASS / 9 unique
Required field completeness	9 complete records	PASS / 9 complete
Duplicate candidates	SRC-003 and SRC-007	PASS / both excluded
Missing-contact hold	SRC-010	PASS / unresolved, not invented

Before / after correction sampling

Source	Source value	Published value	Reason
SRC-001	NorthWay Office Supplies	Northway Office Supplies	Trim and canonicalize
SRC-004	laurel brook studio	Laurel Brook Studio	Verified title casing
SRC-006	ga	GA	State-code normalization
SRC-010	[email blank]	[not published]	Hold; no fabricated address

08 / WORD PRODUCTION

Advanced Word mail-merge demonstration

The companion BONUS_Word_Mail_Merge_Master.docx contains true Word MERGEFIELD fields. The nine-row CSV supplies recipients and BONUS_Finished_Merged_Letters_9.docx shows the rendered output. This is a complete data-to-document process, not a screenshot.

Artifact	Practical competency
SOURCE_customer_intake_12.csv	Controlled intake and source retention
FINAL_approved_master_9.csv	Standardization and verified output
EXCEPTIONS_and_audit_trail.csv	Data lineage and decision support
BONUS_Word_Mail_Merge_Master.docx	Word field codes, reusable correspondence
BONUS_Finished_Merged_Letters_9.docx	Nine personalized, reviewable notices

Reviewer replay steps

- Open source CSV and filter SRC-003, SRC-007 and SRC-010.
- Check each accepted source ID against the final master; verify capitalization and email transforms.
- In Word, inspect the MERGEFIELD fields using Alt+F9 on Windows (Option+F9 on some Macs).
- Use Mailings > Select Recipients > Use Existing List and select the final-master CSV.
- Compare the merged output recipient count with the nine accepted master rows.

Assessment: evidence supports accurate document/data production. A reviewer should repeat the Mail Merge in a desktop Word installation for environment-specific confirmation.

DEEP-DIVE CASE FILE / DATA-01

Expanded customer intake: 120-record operations cycle

This expansion simulates a second, higher-volume intake cycle independent of the original 12-record project. Every row is fictional; the published master is a deterministic output of a documented decision rule. The supplied CSV files let a reviewer independently reproduce the outcome.

Control total	Value	Evidence
Incoming submissions	120	SOURCE_customer_intake_expanded_120.csv
Accepted unique records	104	FINAL_customer_master_expanded_104.csv
Duplicate submissions	10	EXCEPTIONS_expanded_16.csv
Incomplete or invalid records	6	EXCEPTIONS_expanded_16.csv
Reconciliation	104 + 10 + 6 = 120	FINAL_disposition_register_expanded_120.csv

Data contract and release rules

Field	Format / rule	Failure response
batch_id	Required, unique immutable source identifier	Block if absent or reused
organization_raw	Required; trim whitespace; avoid unjustified legal renaming	Route discrepancies to source owner
contact_raw	Required; normalize spacing only	Hold missing contact
email_raw	Required; trim/lowercase; basic shape validation	Hold malformed, blank, or ambiguous
state_raw	Two-letter U.S. code from approved state list	Hold state not present in dictionary
date_raw	ISO YYYY-MM-DD	Hold impossible dates
channel	Named controlled source	Record lineage for auditing

DEEP-DIVE CASE FILE / DATA-02

Standard operating procedure and audit evidence

- 1. Accept only the 120 immutable source rows; preserve raw values and batch IDs.
- 2. Profile nulls, formats, dates, and duplicate candidates before editing.
- 3. Standardize fields on a separate working layer; do not overwrite the raw intake.
- 4. Validate email shape and required fields; reject unresolved invalid inputs.
- 5. Match email keys against earlier approved records; review same-email duplicates before suppression.
- 6. Publish approved master records only after spot checking source lineage and data dictionary.
- 7. Log duplicates and holds with an owner, next action, reason, and verification status.
- 8. Reconcile source volume to approved and exception volumes before release.

Representative before / after audit entries

Input item	Captured value	Decision	Evidence / disposition
B-006	account006@portfolio.example	APPROVED	Published as K-0006
B-105	ACCOUNT006@PORTFOLIO.EXAMPLE	DUPLICATE	Suppressed; points to earlier unique email
B-115	[blank]	HOLD	Source correction requested
B-116	not-an-email	HOLD	Invalid shape; never guessed

Release criteria

- Reconciliation equals 120; source IDs remain present; duplicate candidate count is 10; held count is 6; accepted count is 104.
- Approved contact keys are unique, and no unresolved record appears in the approved export.
- Exception register includes accountable owner, corrective action, and review state.

DEEP-DIVE CASE FILE / DATA-03

Test protocol, risk scoring and reviewer handoff

Test ID	Procedure	Expected result
DV-01	Count source IDs and check uniqueness	120 unique source IDs
DV-02	Trim/lowercase emails and compute first occurrence	10 repeated emails classified duplicate
DV-03	Check blank/invalid emails	6 holds; none exported
DV-04	Compare approved IDs to published master	104 one-to-one rows
DV-05	Verify 3-way total tie-out	120 = 104 + 10 + 6
DV-06	Change an approved email to blank in Excel	Formula flags HOLD; dashboard count updates
DV-07	Type a duplicate email in practice row	Duplicate detection flags review

Illustrative risk tiers: HIGH - unresolved personal identifiers and duplicate identity collisions; MEDIUM - casing/state normalization needing validation; LOW - harmless spacing correction. These are operational conventions for this simulation, not an external standard.

Reproducibility and honest representation

Work product: simulated intake register, verified master, exception register, Excel checks, and professional correspondence. An interviewee may describe the workflow they built and explain a specific exception but should not claim employer volume or real customer outcomes.

Suggested interview explanation

“I built a repeatable source-to-master workflow for a 120-row fictional intake batch. I separated raw values from corrected records, checked duplicates and missing fields, maintained an exception queue, and tied the final register back to all 120 source IDs.”